

SIGNATURE TALENT

Lars Powell

ACADEMIC



HIRE

◆ 3

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Consulting Contract: Commit Lars and copy target commit ability of another player's CEO or talent. Additionally, pay that card's leverage cost in surplus.

Does Lars know...
Oh yeah, Lars knows them.
But I haven't said who...
Doesn't matter.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 233 / 374

OFFICE LOCATION

Munich

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

Commit this office during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Nat Cat or Mortality clauses.

Has modeled the next hundred years and would prefer a quiet quarter.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 353 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Home & Auto

P&C



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Nat Cat: Any ▲ Regulation ▲ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Fender benders every day, hurricanes every decade, and a jingle stuck in everyone's head.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 018 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Home & Auto

P&C



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Nat Cat: Any ▲ Regulation ▲ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 018 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Corporate Liability

P&C

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Litigation

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Pays when businesses get sued, which is to say, constantly.

P

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 019 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Corporate Liability

P&C

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Litigation

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Pays when businesses get sued, which is to say, constantly.

P

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 019 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Corporate Liability

P&C

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Litigation

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Pays when businesses get sued, which is to say, constantly.

P

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 019 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Workers' Compensation

P&C

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Litigation

▲ Inflation

▲ Mortality

▲ Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Some of these claims will outlive the adjusters.

P

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 032 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Workers' Compensation

P&C

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Litigation

▲ Inflation

▲ Mortality

▲ Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Some of these claims will outlive the adjusters.

P

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 032 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Workers' Compensation

P&C

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Litigation

▲ Inflation

▲ Mortality

▲ Health Price

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Some of these claims will outlive the adjusters.

P

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 032 / 374

SIGNATURE FUNDING SOURCE

Autonomous Auto

P&C

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber x2

Signature: one copy per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

No adverse selection, since the insurer drives the car, and no diversification either, since it drives all of them.

P

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 042 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Wildfire

P&C

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Nat Cat: Wildfire x2

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Mountain views, dry brush, and a reinsurance bill to match.

P

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 022 / 374

STAPLE INVESTMENT

Money Market Fund

STAPLE INVESTMENT

COST

2

SALE

2

any time

STAPLE

Staple: any number per deck.

Boring on purpose.

P

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 070 / 374

Money Market Fund

STAPLE INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

SALE

2

any time

STAPLE

Staple: any number per deck.

Boring on purpose.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 070 / 374

Gold Bullion

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

SALE

2

any time

▲ Rising Interest Rates ▼ Inflation ▼ Long-Term Equity

No dividend, no earnings call, and very heavy.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 093 / 374

Corporate Bonds

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1

each turn

SALE

1

any time

▲ Rising Interest Rates ▲ Credit

Steady coupons until spreads wake up.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 046 / 374

Risk Committee Veto

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 3

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Stress Test that hits you. This cannot Stop an Act of God.

The minutes will reflect that we said no.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 165 / 374

Incident Response Retainer

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 2

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Cyber Stress Test that hits you.

The forensics team is on a plane before the ransom note finishes loading.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 130 / 374

Quota Share Treaty

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

Halve your loss from insurance clauses: Mortality, Longevity, Health Price, Litigation, Cyber, and Nat Cat (round down).

Share the premium, share the pain.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 112 / 374

Quota Share Treaty

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

Halve your loss from insurance clauses: Mortality, Longevity, Health Price, Litigation, Cyber, and Nat Cat (round down).

Share the premium, share the pain.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 112 / 374

Catastrophe XoL Treaty

TREATY



COST

◆ 3

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

Requires a P&C or Specialty funding source. When a Nat Cat Stress Test would cost you more than 4 Surplus, prevent the rest.

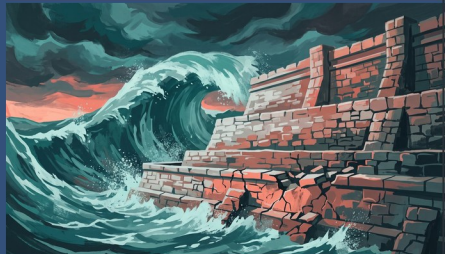
You keep the first loss and hand the reinsurer the rest.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 113 / 374

Catastrophe XoL Treaty

TREATY



COST

◆ 3

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

Requires a P&C or Specialty funding source. When a Nat Cat Stress Test would cost you more than 4 Surplus, prevent the rest.

You keep the first loss and hand the reinsurer the rest.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 113 / 374

RISK MANAGEMENT

Claims Defense Panel

TREATY

COST

◆ 2

Requires a P&C or Specialty funding source.

Halve your loss from Litigation clauses (round down).

Not legal advice, but definitely legal expense.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 118 / 374

RISK MANAGEMENT

Flood Exclusion

RESPONSE

COST

◆ 2

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent all loss to you from this Stress Test's Nat Cat: Flood clauses.

Rising water isn't covered, which everyone reads for the first time after the storm.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 136 / 374

RISK MANAGEMENT

Flood Exclusion

RESPONSE

COST

◆ 2

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent all loss to you from this Stress Test's Nat Cat: Flood clauses.

Rising water isn't covered, which everyone reads for the first time after the storm.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 136 / 374

TALENT

Coverage Counsel

RISK & COMPLIANCE

HIRE

◆ 3

Requires a P&C or Specialty funding source.

Each Litigation clause costs you 1 less Surplus.

Reads the policy wording so the jury doesn't have to.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 189 / 374

TALENT

Chief Actuary

RISK & COMPLIANCE

HIRE

◆ 4

NON-COMPETE

Non-compete: can't be poached.

Requires a Life funding source.

Each Mortality or Longevity clause costs you 1 less Surplus.

Has read every mortality table since 1980 and has opinions about all of them.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 374

TALENT

Internal Auditor

AUDIT

HIRE

◆ 3

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to stop a Reputation or Corporate Stress Test that hits you.

Would like to see the documentation, all of it, by Monday.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 194 / 374

TALENT

Risk Management Professor

ACADEMIC

HIRE

◆ 2

When you hire this employee, search your deck for a Risk Management card, show it, and put it in your hand. Then shuffle your deck.

Wrote the textbook your CRO still keeps on the desk.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 211 / 374

TALENT

Finance Professor

ACADEMIC

HIRE

◆ 2

When you hire this employee, search your deck for an investment, show it, and put it in your hand. Then shuffle your deck.

Has beaten the market in every backtest ever published.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 210 / 374

TOOL

Delegation Dashboard

SOFTWARE

PRICE

◆ 3

Cyber

Commit: Uncommit a different non-funding card you control. Use this ability only once between the starts of your turns.

That meeting could have been somebody else's meeting.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 360 / 374

Grand Bahama

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 3 branch only

Regulation

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 3 Assumed Reinsurance funding sources you control, rounded down.

The treaties cross oceans with the paperwork already in order.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 357 / 374

Whistleblower

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.

She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 298 / 374

Congressional Hearing

REGULATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile and 1 per Dark card on their board.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Feeder Fund it controls.

I don't recall, Senator. I'd have to check with my team. My team has been let go.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 299 / 374

Consent Decree

REGULATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile and 2 per Dark card on their board, plus 4 more. Then they have one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

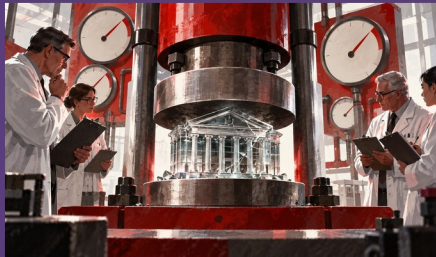
No admission of wrongdoing, just a very large check and a new board.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 300 / 374

Supervisory Stress Test

REGULATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

Credit Liquidity

Target opponent loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure, 3 per Liquidity exposure, and 1 per Dark card on their board. Then they can't add a funding source on their next turn.

The regulators ran their annual stress test, and this year you were the stress.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 305 / 374

Telematics Devices

HARDWARE



PRICE

◆ 4

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

Cyber

Requires a P&C funding source.

Your P&C funding sources have +1 Margin.

Knows how hard you brake, how fast you corner, and where you really were on Tuesday night.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 370 / 374

Basel III Endgame

REGULATION - AS-IF REPLAY, 2023



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Regulation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Regulation exposure, plus 5 more. Then each company discards a card.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Rated Feeder Note it controls.

In July 2023, U.S. regulators proposed the Basel III endgame, which would have raised big banks' capital requirements by about 16%.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 275 / 374

Solvency II

REGULATION - AS-IF REPLAY, 2016



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Regulation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Regulation exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Rated Feeder Note it controls.

On January 1, 2016, Solvency II took effect for insurers across the European Union, after more than a decade of consultation and several delays.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 288 / 374

IFRS 17

REGULATION - AS-IF REPLAY, 2023



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 1 Surplus per Dark card on its board. Then each company discards its hand and draws that many cards.

On January 1, 2023, IFRS 17, the first full international accounting standard for insurance contracts, took effect. Effective for fiscal years beginning after the one you planned for.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 294 / 374

Spitzer Broker Probe

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2004



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Dark card in its discard pile.

In October 2004, New York's attorney general sued the largest insurance broker for steering clients and rigging bids, in a probe that reached the whole industry.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 301 / 374

Off-Channel Communications Sweep

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 3 Surplus per employee it controls other than its CEO, 1 per Dark card on its board, and 1 per Dark card in its discard pile.

In 2022 US regulators fined sixteen banks and brokers more than \$1.8 billion for business discussed on personal phones. No wrongdoing was found in the messages; the messages were the wrongdoing.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 307 / 374

Gov. Stress Test

REGULATION



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Run a copy of the most recent Surprise Inspection in each company's discard pile. Each copy hits every company, even if it normally targets one opponent.

The regulator's goal is to prevent the last crisis, not the next one.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 314 / 374

Assets Nationalized

REGULATION



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company discards every Investment without Sale proceeds.

The portfolio is now a public service.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 333 / 374

Affordable Care Act

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In March 2010, the Affordable Care Act became law and rewrote the rules of American health insurance. Every four years, half the actuaries update their assumptions and the other half update their resumes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 250 / 374

Liberation Day Tariffs

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2025



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Inflation ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure, 6 per Inflation exposure, and 3 per Volatility exposure.

On April 2, 2025, the United States announced tariffs on imports from nearly every country; stocks fell more than 10% in two days, and a week later most of the increases were paused.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 261 / 374

Great Bond Massacre

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1994



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Rising Interest Rates ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Rising Interest Rates exposure and 3 per Volatility exposure.

On February 4, 1994, the Federal Reserve raised rates by surprise and kept raising them all year, and bond prices fell around the world. Orange County found out in December.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 303 / 374

Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 287 / 374

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 234 / 374

AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE
▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.
Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.
On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD
▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.
Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.
On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE
▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.
Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.
In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE
▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.
Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.
In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.